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Fixme1.py

fixme1.py 



Easy General Skills Beginner picoMini 2022 Python

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Description

Fix the syntax error in this Python script to print the flag.

[Download Python script](#)

Hints ?

1 2 3 4

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picoCTF{FLAG}

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Flag

Author: The Analyst: Hyposelenia

Challenge: Fixme.py

Category: General Skills

Date: 01/14/26



I. Objective

Fix the syntax error in the provided Python script so that it executes correctly and prints the hidden flag.

II. Background

Python is a whitespace-sensitive programming language, meaning indentation is not just for readability but is part of the language's syntax. Incorrect indentation can cause runtime errors that prevent a program from executing. This challenge tests basic Python debugging skills by identifying and correcting an indentation error.

III. Tool Used

- **Oracle VirtualBox (Kali Linux)** – Used as the Linux environment
- **Linux Terminal** – Used to execute decoding commands
- **Programiz (Online Python Interpreter)** – Used to quickly test and identify syntax errors

IV. Methodology

1. Downloaded the provided Python file (fixme1.py)
2. Ran the script using a Python interpreter
3. Observed the error message indicating an indentation issue



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```
main.py
1 import random
2
3
4
5 def str_xor(secret, key):
6     #extend key to secret length
7     new_key = key
8     i = 0
9     while len(new_key) < len(secret):
10         new_key = new_key + key[i]
11         i = (i + 1) % len(key)
12     return "".join([chr(ord(secret_c) ^ ord(new_key_c)) for (secret_c,new_key_c) in zip
13                     (secret,new_key)])
14
15 flag_enc = chr(0x15) + chr(0x07) + chr(0x08) + chr(0x06) + chr(0x27) + chr(0x21) + chr(0x23)
16             + chr(0x15) + chr(0x5a) + chr(0x07) + chr(0x00) + chr(0x46) + chr(0x0b) + chr(0x1a) + chr
17             (0x5a) + chr(0x1d) + chr(0x1d) + chr(0x2a) + chr(0x06) + chr(0x1c) + chr(0x5a) + chr(0x5c
18             ) + chr(0x55) + chr(0x40) + chr(0x3a) + chr(0x5e) + chr(0x52) + chr(0x0c) + chr(0x01) +
19             chr(0x42) + chr(0x57) + chr(0x59) + chr(0x0a) + chr(0x14)
20
21
22 flag = str_xor(flag_enc, 'enkidu')
23 print('That is correct! Here's your flag: ' + flag)
```

Output

ERROR!
Traceback (most recent call last):
 File "<main.py>", line 19
 print('That is correct! Here's your flag: ' + flag)
IndentationError: unexpected indent

=== Code Exited With Errors ===

4. Checked the line number specified in the error (line 19)
5. Noticed that the print statement was incorrectly indented
6. Removed the extra indentation to align it with the previous line
7. Re-ran the script and successfully retrieved the flag

V. Result

picoCTF{1nd3nt1ty_cr1515_09ee727a}

```
Programiz
Python Online Compiler

Canva Ang business mo, pwede na magka-logo!
Design for free

main.py
1 #extend key to secret length
2 new_key = key
3 i = 0
4 while len(new_key) < len(secret):
5     new_key = new_key + key[i]
6     i = (i + 1) % len(key)
7 return "".join([chr(ord(secret_c) ^ ord(new_key_c)) for
8                 (secret_c,new_key_c) in zip(secret,new_key)])
9
10
11 flag_enc = chr(0x15) + chr(0x07) + chr(0x08) + chr(0x06) + chr(0x27)
12             + chr(0x21) + chr(0x23) + chr(0x15) + chr(0x5a) + chr(0x07) +
13             chr(0x00) + chr(0x46) + chr(0x0b) + chr(0x1a) + chr(0x5a) + chr
14             (0x1d) + chr(0x1d) + chr(0x2a) + chr(0x06) + chr(0x1c) + chr
15             (0x5a) + chr(0x5c) + chr(0x55) + chr(0x40) + chr(0x3a) + chr
16             (0x5e) + chr(0x52) + chr(0x0c) + chr(0x01) + chr(0x42) + chr
17             (0x57) + chr(0x59) + chr(0x0a) + chr(0x14)
18
19 flag = str_xor(flag_enc, 'enkidu')
20 print('That is correct! Here's your flag: ' + flag)
```

Output

That is correct! Here's your flag: picoCTF{1nd3nt1ty_cr1515_09ee727a}

=== Code Execution Successful ===



VI. Explanation

The error encountered was:

IndentationError: unexpected indent

In Python, indentation defines code blocks such as loops, conditionals, and functions. The print statement in the script was indented even though it was not inside any block, causing Python to raise an error.

Problematic code:

```
flag = str_xor(flag_enc, 'enkidu')  
print('That is correct! Here\'s your flag: ' + flag)
```

The print statement has extra leading spaces, making Python interpret it as belonging to a block that does not exist.

Corrected code:

```
flag = str_xor(flag_enc, 'enkidu')  
print('That is correct! Here\'s your flag: ' + flag)
```

Once the indentation was fixed, the script executed properly, decrypted the encoded flag using XOR, and printed the correct result.

VII. Conclusion

This challenge highlights the importance of proper indentation in Python programming. Even a small formatting mistake can prevent an otherwise correct program from running. Understanding how Python interprets indentation is essential for debugging scripts and working effectively with Python in cybersecurity challenges and real-world applications.

— The Analyst: Hyposelenia